

MARKETPLACE INTELLIGENCE BRIEFING

TrustMRR

What 1,000 acquirable SaaS businesses reveal about where revenue, quality, and risk really concentrate

Prepared for the TrustMRR Founding Team

Sample: 1,000 listings · 65 countries · 29 categories · Data frozen 30 Jul 2026

Five things the founders need to know

- 01** **Revenue is a power law, not a bell curve** The top 5% of listings (50 companies) generate 73% of all revenue. This is a whale-driven marketplace — GMV, not listing count, is the real growth lever.
- 02** **Volume and quality point at different categories** AI leads on total revenue (\$2.36M) simply on count (197 listings). Marketing monetizes 7x more efficiently per subscriber (\$353 vs. AI's \$51) — a much better acquisition target per unit of sales effort.
- 03** **Geography is wildly uneven, in a good way** Singapore's 9 listings out-earn Germany's 24 by 4x on a per-company basis. A small, curated regional expansion can beat broad geographic scaling.
- 04** **Payment provider is a quality signal** Superwall-processed businesses earn 2.4x the revenue of Paddle peers on similar volume — worth treating as a soft underwriting signal, not just plumbing.
- 05** **The best inventory is hiding in plain sight** Anonymous / stealth listings earn 2.5x more on average than named ones (\$32K vs. \$13K). Anonymity correlates with premium, not risk, in this sample.

DATASET OVERVIEW

A broad but imperfectly-tagged sample

1,000

Listings

29

Data fields per listing

65

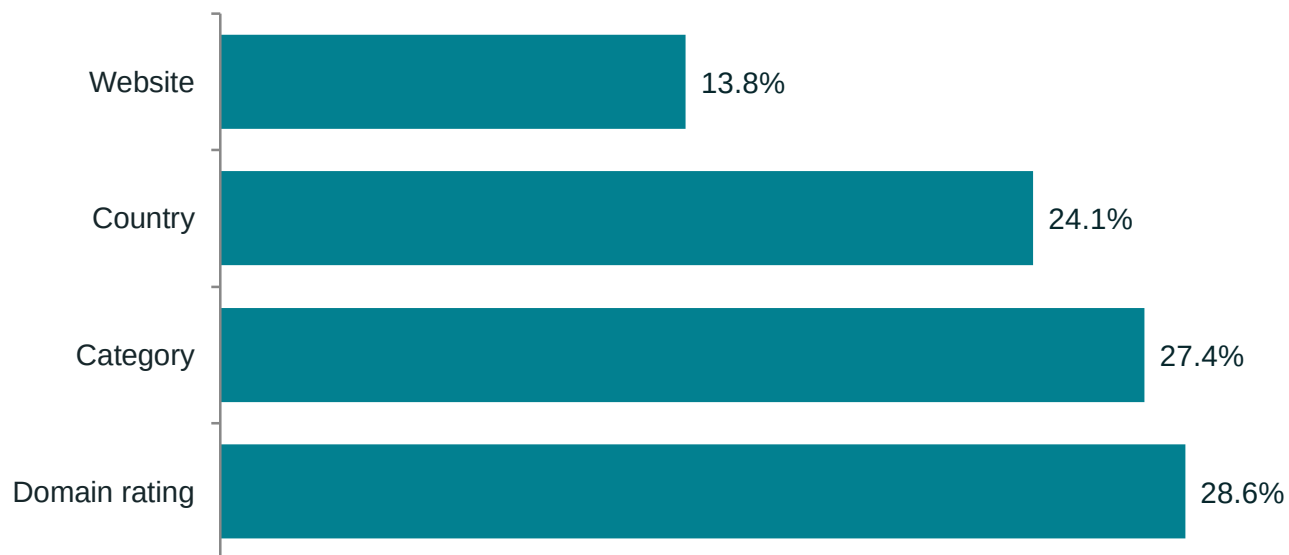
Countries represented

29

Startup categories

WHERE COVERAGE BREAKS DOWN

Share of listings with a blank value, by field



SO WHAT?

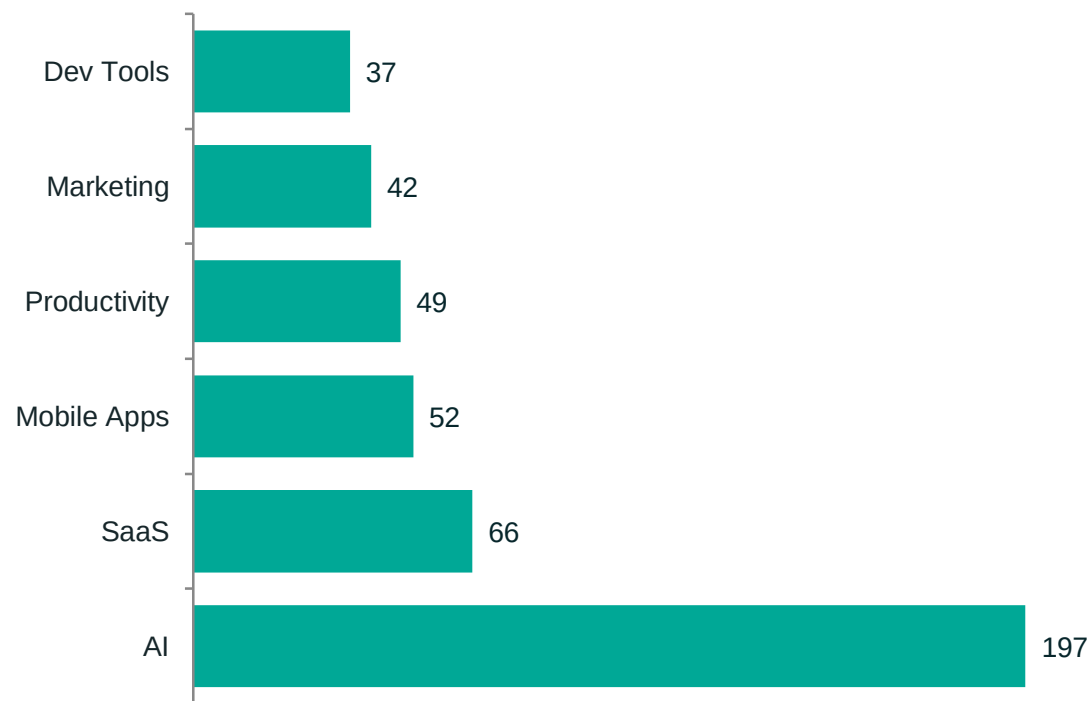
Nearly 3 in 10 listings lack an SEO authority score, and a similar share lack a category tag. Buyers and investors doing quick screening will systematically under-value or overlook a meaningful slice of good inventory simply because it isn't tagged.

A US- and AI-heavy marketplace, long-tailed everywhere

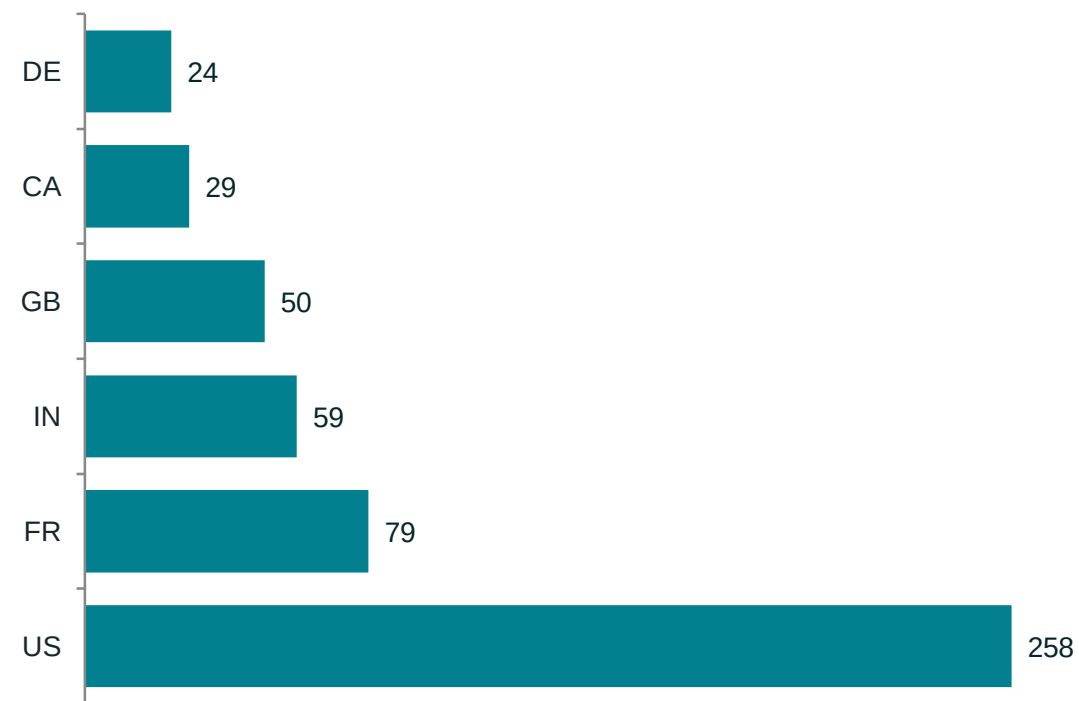
\$15.6M

total trailing 30-day revenue across all 1,000 listings — the base from which every insight in this deck is drawn.

TOP CATEGORIES BY LISTING COUNT

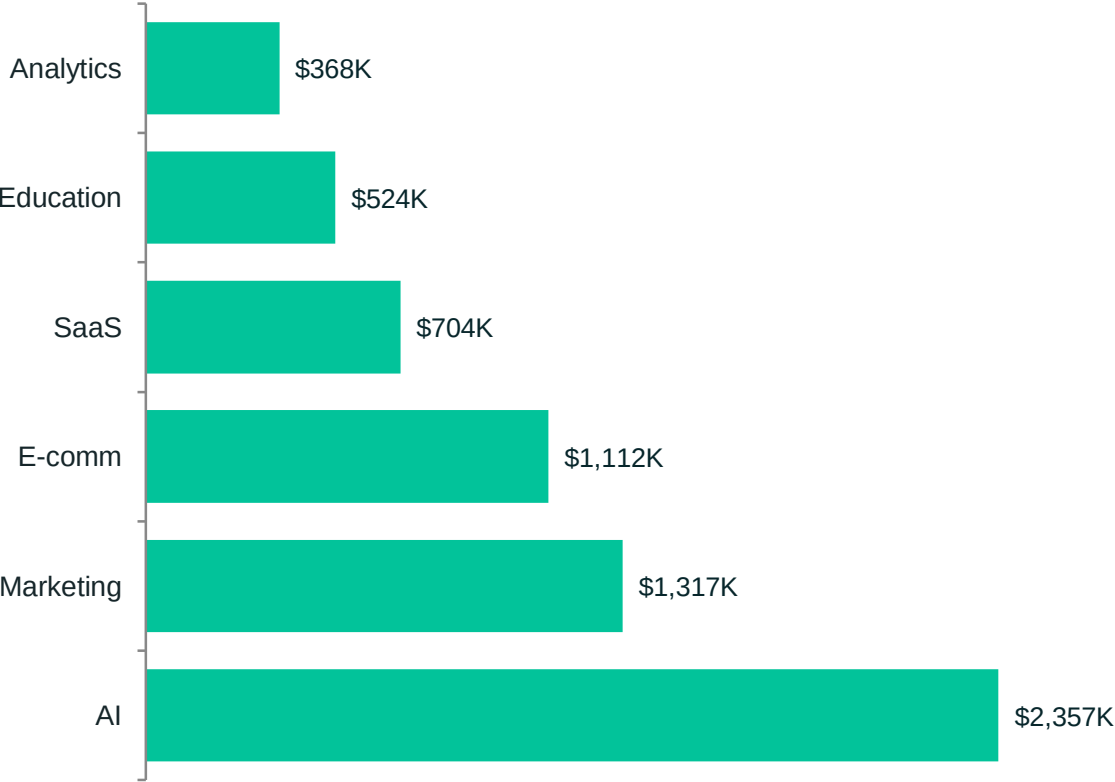


TOP COUNTRIES BY LISTING COUNT

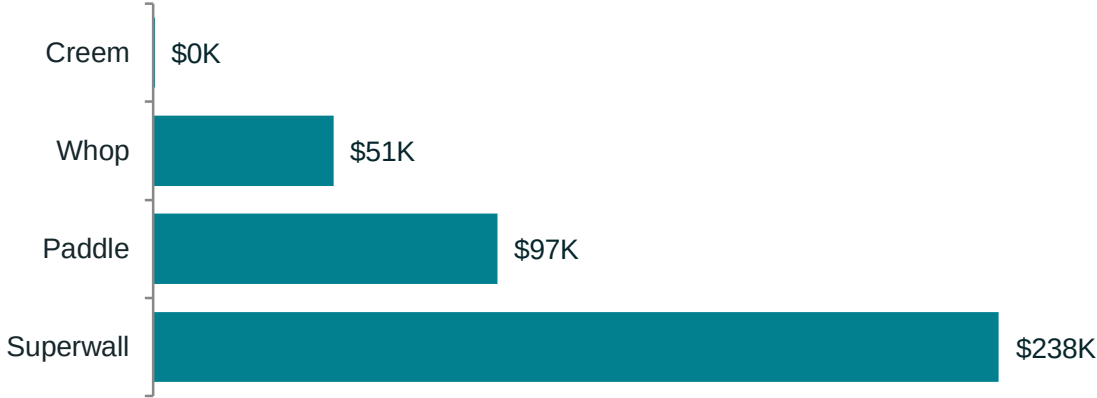


Where the \$15.6M actually comes from

TOP CATEGORIES BY 30-DAY REVENUE (USD)



REVENUE BY PAYMENT PROVIDER (4 COMPARED)



SO WHAT?

AI wins on total revenue mostly because it has 5x more listings than any other category, not because each business is bigger. Superwall-processed businesses earn 2.4x Paddle's per-provider total on 17 vs. 16 listings — a much stronger per-company signal.

Translating the verified findings into decisions

1 The SEO signal is missing where it matters

286 of 1,000 listings (29%) carry no domain-authority score. Diligence teams screening on SEO strength alone are working from an incomplete map, not a bad one — worth a manual pass before ruling anything out.

2 E-commerce's median hides its outliers

The typical E-comm listing runs a modest \$155/month in MRR, yet the category banks \$1.1M in 30-day revenue overall. A handful of large sellers — not the category as a whole — are doing the heavy lifting.

3 Dev Tools is a steady, unglamorous earner

37 Dev Tools listings post \$163K in combined 30-day revenue — smaller than AI or Marketing, but spread across enough companies to suggest a durable, less winner-take-all niche worth a closer look for lower-risk acquisitions.

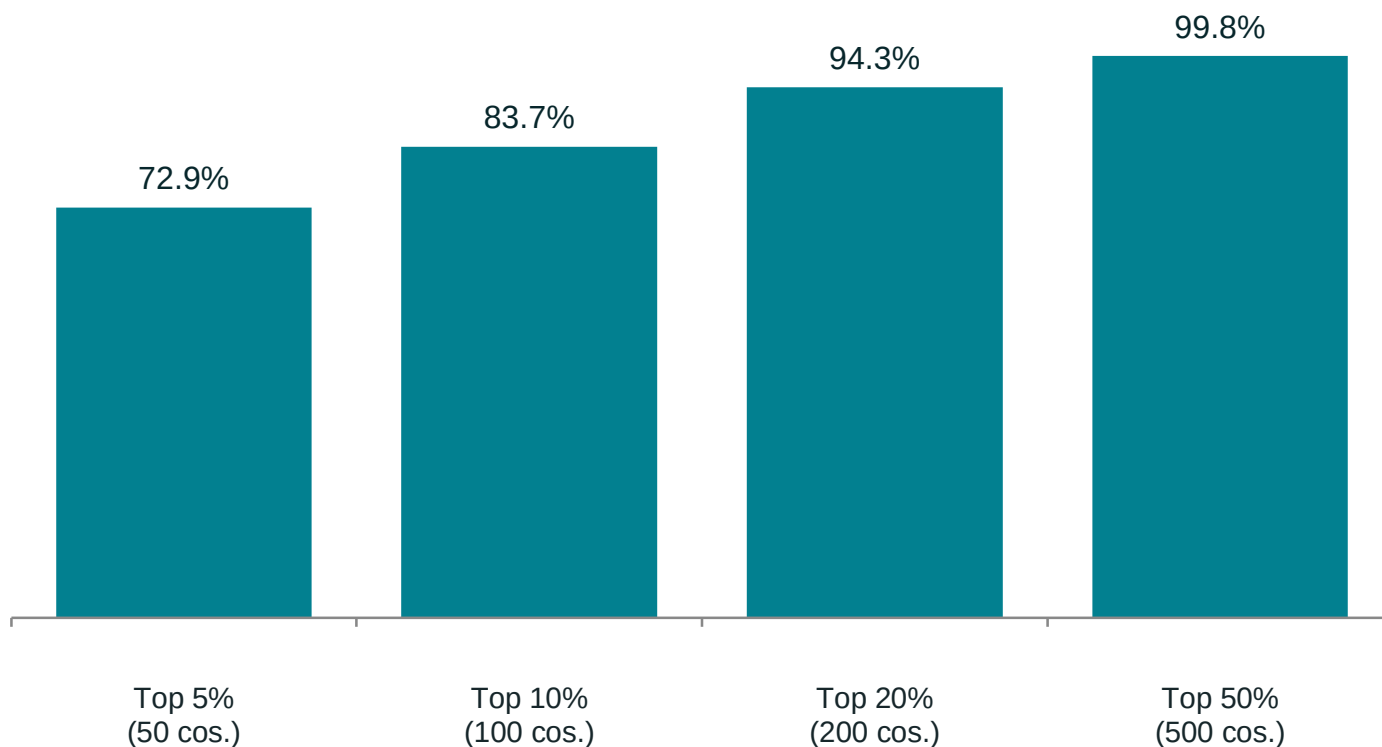
4 Singapore over-delivers relative to its size

9 Singapore-based listings generate \$172K — more than Germany's 24 listings (\$42K) combined. On a per-company basis that's roughly a 4x advantage, hinting at a higher-quality regional pipeline worth deliberate sourcing.

Is revenue concentrated among a few companies?

WHY IT MATTERS

Concentration risk is one of the first questions any investment committee asks of a marketplace: does growth depend on a handful of whales, or a broad, resilient base? Method: sort all 1,000 listings by 30-day revenue, then measure the cumulative revenue share held by the top 5%, 10%, 20%, and 50% of listings.



EXPECTED INSIGHT

This is a whale-driven marketplace.

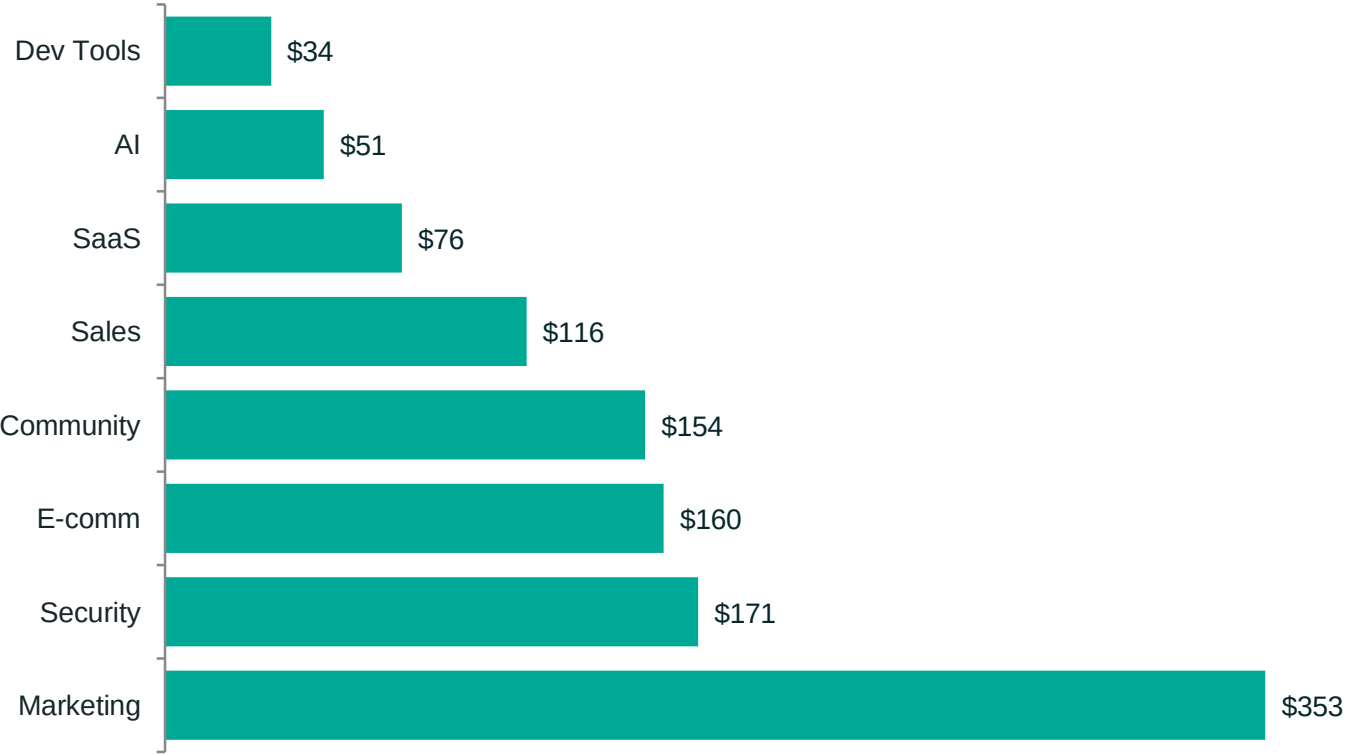
Half of all companies (the bottom 50%) contribute barely 0.2% of revenue. The top 50 listings alone — 5% of the marketplace — already account for nearly three-quarters of GMV.

So what: growth strategy, pricing, and retention resources should be weighted toward protecting and expanding the top decile — not spread evenly across the catalog.

Which categories monetize each subscriber best?

WHY IT MATTERS

Total category revenue rewards scale; it says nothing about how well a business monetizes the customers it already has. Method: for categories with 5+ listings and disclosed subscriber counts, divide total 30-day revenue by total active subscriptions to get revenue-per-subscriber.



EXPECTED INSIGHT

Scale and efficiency point at different winners.

Marketing extracts \$353 per subscriber — 7x AI's \$51 — despite AI having 5x more listings and 2x more total revenue. AI's revenue comes from having many subscribers, not high-value ones.

So what: for acquisition or partnership targeting, Marketing and Security listings offer more monetization headroom per customer than the flashier AI category.

Subscribers predict revenue — and anonymity pays a premium

CORRELATION

$$r = 0.802$$

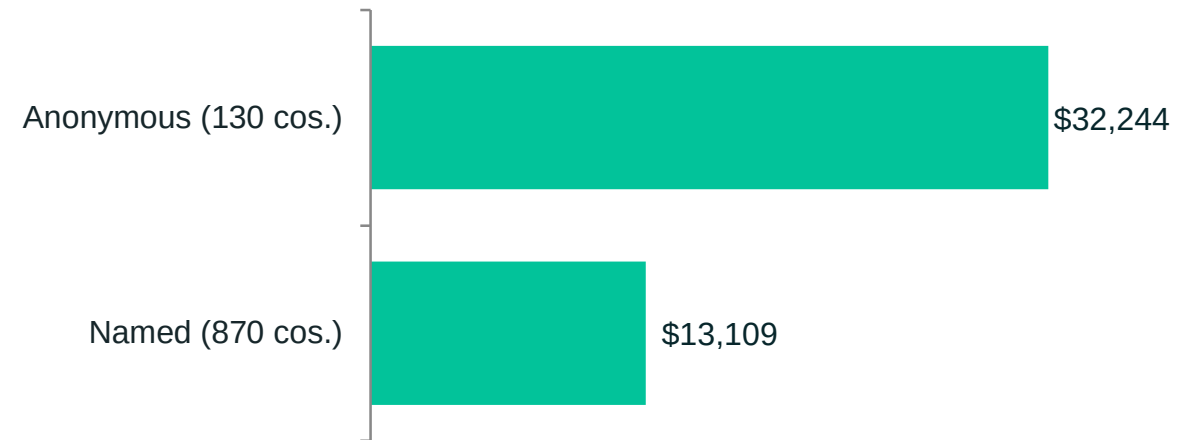
Active subscriptions vs. 30-day revenue, across all 1,000 listings with complete data

A very strong positive relationship: subscriber count is a reliable proxy for revenue scale in this marketplace, and can be used to triage listings when revenue data is missing or unverified.

Caveat: correlation is not causation — pricing, category, and geography likely all move together with subscriber count.

NAMED VS. ANONYMOUS LISTINGS

Average 30-day revenue per company



Anonymous listings are only 13% of the marketplace by count but 27% of total revenue — and earn 2.5x more per company on average. Stealth mode appears to correlate with more mature, higher-revenue operators protecting a competitive position, not with lower-quality or unverifiable businesses.

If we were running TrustMRR, we would do this

1

Protect and grow the top decile

Build retention and success programs around the ~10% of listings that drive 84% of revenue — treat them as key accounts, not self-serve listings.

2

Build a curated Singapore sourcing motion

Deliberately recruit SG-based sellers; the region shows a 4x revenue-per-company advantage over comparable markets like Germany.

3

Court Marketing and Security sellers, not just AI

These categories monetize 3-7x more per subscriber than AI — a better fit for any program that rewards revenue quality over listing volume.

4

Close the SEO and category tagging gap

Fix or enrich the ~28% of listings missing domain rating and category tags before they reach buyers — this data gap is actively suppressing good inventory.

5

Design outreach specifically for anonymous sellers

This segment already earns a 2.5x revenue premium; a dedicated, discreet onboarding path could unlock disproportionate GMV.

What could make this story wrong



Self-selection bias

Listings are sellers who opted to list on TrustMRR — likely skewed toward businesses ready to exit, not a random sample of all SaaS companies.



Small-sample country comparisons

The Singapore vs. Germany comparison rests on 9 and 24 listings respectively — a few large or small outliers could meaningfully shift the ranking.



Correlation vs. causation

The 0.802 link between subscribers and revenue is an association, not proof that growing subscribers alone drives revenue growth.



Missing data is not random

28-29% gaps in domain rating and category may correlate with newer or smaller sellers, which could bias category- and quality-level conclusions.



Concentration cuts both ways

Heavy dependence on the top 5% of listings for 73% of revenue is also a fragility: losing a handful of top accounts would materially move total GMV.

Is TrustMRR an attractive marketplace?

Conditional yes — a high-quality core, wrapped in fixable data problems.

THE BULL CASE

- Very strong revenue-subscriber correlation ($r = 0.802$) — the fundamentals are real, not noise
- A genuine premium segment exists: top 5% of listings, Singapore sellers, and anonymous operators all outperform on a per-company basis
- 26% of listings are actively for sale — healthy marketplace liquidity

THE CONDITION

- ~28% of listings are missing category or domain-authority data — today's screening tools are working with an incomplete picture
- Revenue is concentrated: the top 5% of companies hold 73% of GMV, so retention of a small number of accounts matters disproportionately
- Country and category comparisons often rest on small sub-samples (9-40 listings) and need larger data before being fully trusted

Every metric calculated in this deck

#	Question	Result
Q1	Listings with blank domain_rating	286 / 1,000 (28.6%)
Q2	Companies on Superwall (API key)	17
Q3	Dev Tools — 30-day revenue	\$163,402 across 37 listings
Q4	E-comm — median MRR	\$155 (19 listings)
Q5	Highest revenue among DE / AU / NL / SG	Singapore — \$172,218 (9 listings)
Q6	Highest-revenue payment provider (of 4)	Superwall — \$237,834
Q7	Named vs. anonymous revenue split	Named \$11.40M (870) · Anon \$4.19M (130)
Q8	Correlation: active subscriptions vs. revenue	$r = 0.802$
Q9	Revenue held by top 5% / 10% / 20% / 50% of listings	72.9% / 83.7% / 94.3% / 99.8%
Q10	Highest revenue-per-subscriber category	Marketing — \$353/subscriber